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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Innovate Academy

School Website: <https://www.innovateacademy.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Innovate Academy (Chadds Ford, PA, 19317) presents as a church-affiliated classical Christian school operating in the Chen or Delaware County area (Calvary Chapel Delaware County network). Public materials consistently label it as a "classical Christian school," which signals a strong religious/metaphysical foundation and a classical branding. Evidence from the crawl indicates focus on faith formation, worship, and family discipleship, with explicit ties to a church context (e.g., Calvary Chapel Delaware County). However, explicit classical curriculum specifics (e.g., Great Books, grammar–logic–rhetoric sequence, Latin, or a clearly codified Trivium/Quadrivium approach) and explicit classical pedagogy (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholê, or rigorous rhetorical training) are not clearly articulated in the materials available from the site. The school does show a family-oriented community ecosystem (Journey Kids, parental engagement through church and school activities), but the explicit articulation of what would render it a full classical program on all six rubric categories is incomplete.

Overall, the school leans toward CLASSICAL in its religious/theological orientation but shows weaker alignment in fully explicit classical curricular and pedagogical signatures across the six-element rubric. The aggregate assessment is **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school identifies itself as a "classical Christian school," signaling a trans-hypostatic foundation that integrates faith with learning (PreK–9th grade classical Christian school). - Public materials describe God-centered language and worship-oriented activities (e.g., "begin our journey to share God's love ... through our words, actions, and worship"). - Content from related church materials references Scripture, Bible memory, and discipleship themes (Journey Kids; JKids) that accompany the school program, reinforcing a liturgical/communal spiritual framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators found: theology, worship, God's love, discipleship, sacred/communal religious life (e.g., "classical Christian school," "worship," "Bible memory," "discipling"). These correspond to positive signals in the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations lexicon (theology, liturgy, worship, wonder, etc.). - Negative indicators: none clearly evident in public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or other negative signals appear in the visible excerpts).

Why this rating - The material presents a robust religious/metaphysical foundation (theology/worship/discipleship) and explicitly labels the school as classical Christian, which aligns with the Positive signals for this category. The absence of overt secular or contradicting signals reinforces CLASSICAL in this area.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize formation, faith-driven aims, and a sense of formation around God-centered aims rather than purely vocational preparation. The phrase “classical Christian school” signals a traditional educational telos beyond job training. - The Journey Kids/JKids material suggests a family/discipleship orientation and ongoing relational formation within the faith community (e.g., Bible memory, family discipleship, worship-centered programming).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: formation, virtue-related language, pursuit of truth/faith, classical mission (as indicated by “classical Christian school”). The explicit Great Conversation/Great Books language is not present in the visible site text, which limits the full Classical alignment for this category. - Negative indicators: none explicit in the public materials; however, absence of explicit classical aims like “great books,” “liberal arts telos” or “truth/beauty/virtue through the Great Conversation” reduces the strength of a full CLASSICAL signal.

Why this rating - The school shows formation-oriented aims rooted in Christian formation and discipleship, which is consistent with the classical tradition’s focus on formation of character and wisdom. Yet, without clear articulation of classical telos elements (e.g., truth–goodness–beauty as knowable, or explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language), the score remains SOMETIME CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site describes the school as “classical Christian,” but explicit curricular components aligned with classical education (liberal arts framework, Grammar–Logic–Rhetoric sequence, Great Books, Latin, or Quadrivium/Trivium) are not explicitly documented in the available public material. The curriculum references include “PreK–8th grade classical Christian school” with biblical/theological framing and a curriculum note about “Answers in Genesis Curriculum” for some age bands (which emphasizes biblical content rather than a stated classical liberal arts sequence). - No explicit mention of Great Books, Great Conversation, logic or rhetoric training, Latin or Greek, or a formal Trivium/Quadrivium progression in the accessible public materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: the label “classical Christian school” itself is a positive signal for a classical framing, but this category requires explicit curricular elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; history as history; etc.), which are not clearly listed in the sources. - Negative indicators present: lack of explicit classical curriculum keywords (Great Books, Trivium, Quadrivium, Latin/foreign languages, history-as-history, etc.). The visible materials emphasize biblical content and church-related curriculum rather than a canonical classical curriculum.

Why this rating - Because explicit classical curriculum components (grammar–logic–rhetoric, Great Books/Great Conversation, liberal arts sequencing) are not clearly documented in the public materials, this category does not reach the CLASSICAL standard, and is better characterized as NOT CLASSICAL in curriculum terms based on the available evidence.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize faith formation and worship-related experience, with limited explicit mention of classical pedagogical methods such as Socratic dialogue, scholé, or a rigorous Trivium-based approach. The site highlights roles like “Head of School,” “Music mentor,” and youth ministry staff, rather than a structured classical pedagogy framework. - There is mention of a church context and family discipleship activities, but not a clear articulation of contemplative, Socratic seminars, or rhetoric-based public speaking programs as core pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators for classical pedagogy would include terms like Socratic seminar, scholé, memory work, recitation, dialectic, etc. None of these appear in the visible public materials in a sustained manner. - Negative indicators: the dominant religious, worship, and discipleship language with limited classical pedagogical vocabulary. This pushes the category toward NOT CLASSICAL pedagogically.

Why this rating - Without explicit Classical pedagogy (Socratic dialogue, memory work, recitation, or a sustained schol  approach), the category does not align with the classical pedagogy rubric. The visible content leans more toward faith-driven formation and ministry-oriented activities rather than a rigorous classical teaching method.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials identify a formal leadership structure (e.g., Head of School) and named staff (e.g., Monica Guaglione, Head of School; Ken Frieson, Middle School Pastor; Nichole Peta, Family Ministry Operations Manager). This signals a structured faculty and leadership corps rather than anonymous teaching staff. - The presence of a “living curriculum” concept is not explicitly stated, but the faculty are positioned as faith-mentors in a church-linked setting, which in classical terms can align with a model where mentors embody and convey the formation goals. However, explicit classical faculty descriptors (portrait of teacher, living curriculum, faculty of friends, etc.) are not directly stated.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: named senior leader and staff, indicating a professional faculty structure; the integration of staff with faith formation roles (e.g., “Middle School Pastor”) aligns with the classical emphasis on a virtuous teacher as exemplar and mentor. - Negative indicators: lack of explicit language about living curriculum, classical teacher portraits, or collegial teacher culture beyond standard roles. The available materials do not present the classical faculty image in the explicit lexicon of the Six Essential Elements.

Why this rating - The visible signs point to a structured faculty with faith-embedded leadership and roles. While this does not fully meet the classical faculty portraits described in the canonical lexicon (e.g., “living curriculum” teachers), the presence of named leaders and faith-mentoring roles provides a partial alignment, justifying SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL in pedagogy/faculty alignment.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The program includes family/disciple-making elements (Journey Kids, JKids at Home, parent involvement in safety and church-related activities), indicating ongoing partnership with parents and a community-centered model. The JKids program and family discipleship language signal active engagement with parents/guardians. - There is evidence of a public-facing partnership model with families (e.g., events, ministries, and faith-based programming) and a willingness to engage families in school-related activities through church-affiliated channels.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: partnership with parents, co-educating families through faith-based programs, family discipleship, open access to ministry-related content (Beliefs, Our Story, etc.). These map to the “Parents and Community” positive signals in the Six Elements lexicon (parent formation, seminars, open campus, parent covenant, etc.). - Negative indicators: explicit “co-teacher” dynamic (parents as co-teachers) is not fully documented in the public materials; while there is strong parent/community engagement, the explicit co-teacher framework is not clearly stated.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates meaningful parent/community engagement typical of classical Christian settings (family involvement, discipleship, events). However, explicit articulation of “parents as co-teachers” or formal parent-education offerings beyond church/faith activities is not clearly documented in the visible materials. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for this category.

Aggregate assessment - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 6: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Add explicit Great Books/Great Conversation framing to the Curriculum section (e.g., list liberal arts components, canonical texts, and a clear Trivium progression).

- Make the classical pedagogy explicit (Socratic seminars, scholé, memory work, recitation, and rhetoric training) and demonstrate how these practices are implemented from K–12.
- Develop a clearly stated “living curriculum” concept for Faculty, including teacher professional development in classical pedagogy and a documented teacher portrait aligned with classical aims.
- Publish explicit language around the core classical telos (truth, goodness, beauty) and how these ideals are pursued across subjects, with examples in history, literature, and language arts.
- Strengthen explicit parent education and partnership programs (e.g., parent seminars, book studies, and a formal “parents as co-teachers” framework) to more clearly map onto classical school norms.
- Align the history curriculum with traditional classical emphasis (history as an ongoing through-line in all disciplines rather than a stand-alone “social studies” frame) and incorporate Great Books or primary-source readings where possible.
- Elevate science and humanities integration to demonstrate how the liberal arts approach informs STEM and humanities, with clear mapping to the Trivium/Quadrivium framework and the Great Conversation ethos.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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